

Penguin

Penguins are among the oddest birds that live on Earth. For one thing, they cannot fly. Here, we follow the extraordinary life cycle of emperor penguins in freezing Antarctica.

From the sea

When it is time to mate, emperor penguins travel from the sea about 56 miles (90 km) inland until they reach the icy breeding site.

Penguins bow their heads as a sign of courtship before mating.

Mating

Penguins court and mate around March to April. The temperature is as low as -104°F (-40°C).

Laying eggs

Emperor penguins lay their eggs between May and June. Each female produces a single egg.

The egg weighs about 1 lb (450 g).

Incubating

From June to July, the mother gives her egg to the father to look after, while she returns to the sea. The male keeps the egg warm before it hatches, a process called incubation.

The male places the egg on his feet and covers it with a skin fold, called a brood pouch.